

Runbooks definition

A Runbook is a governed execution contract that an [AI Coworker](#) or [AI Expert](#) may invoke to achieve a goal. AI Coworkers “think”, Runbooks govern how thinking becomes action, runbooks may contain

Workflows (which execute the work).

- Runbooks captures:
 - Intent and boundaries
 - Approved reasoning and execution paths
 - Deterministic workflows where precision matters
 - Clear handoffs between humans, AI reasoning, and systems
- a Runbook requires an “executor” which may be an AI Agent, Expert or Coworker.
 - A Runbook does not replace an AI Coworker.
 - A Runbook is what an AI Coworker uses to act safely, repeatedly, and audibly.

Core Principles

1. **Text-first**

- A Runbook always begins as plain language intent
- It may remain text-only or expand into structured execution

2. **Composable**

- A Runbook may include one or more workflows
- A workflow may be reused across multiple Runbooks
- A Runbook can call other Runbooks

3. **Coworker-invoked**

- Runbooks are executed *by* AI Agents, not by users directly (except explicitly allowed cases)
- The Agent decides *when* to invoke a Runbook
- The Runbook governs *how* execution proceeds

4. **Deterministic-ish**

- AI reasoning is explicitly bounded
- Deterministic steps exit the AI context as early as possible

Scope of a Runbook

A Runbook may represent any of the following:

- A single prompt with output constraints

- A SOP
- A decision tree with limited AI reasoning
- A workflow-backed process (monitor, automation, report)
- A multi-stage operational procedure

Runbook vs Workflow (Explicit Relationship)

Workflow

A **Workflow** is:

- A deterministic execution graph
- Composed of typed nodes (evaluate, transform, action, output)
- Fully machine-driven
- Fully replayable

Runbook

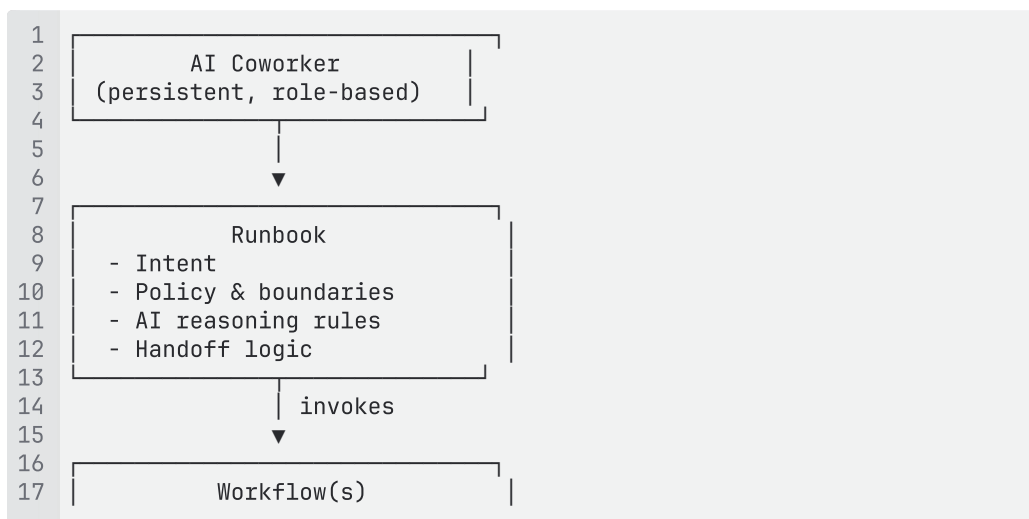
A **Runbook**:

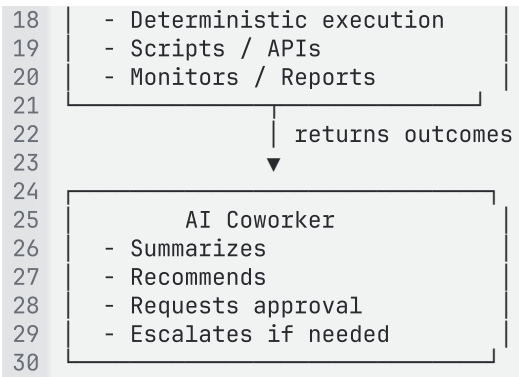
- Describes intent and policy
- Selects and sequences workflows
- Defines where AI reasoning is allowed
- Defines escalation, handoff, and approval behavior

A workflow is a component of a Runbook.

A Runbook is the operational wrapper that makes workflows safe to use with AI Coworkers.

Runbook Example (Workflow-Backed)





Example

```
1 | Intent:
2 | When CPU exceeds threshold, enrich the incident and recommend
  | remediation.
3 |
4 | Steps:
5 | 1. Evaluate CPU threshold (workflow)
6 | 2. Ask AI to classify likely cause (bounded reasoning)
7 | 3. Enrich ticket with context (workflow)
8 | 4. Recommend remediation (no auto-execute)
```